

THOMAS DANIELSON

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Summary – People-first quant, with deep experience listening to investors to understand their questions and the context around the investment risks they are balancing. Investment risk modeling can become more complex than is necessary, compromising interpretability and utility for investors. Additionally, defining modeling needs with detailed specifications can be time-consuming. To mitigate this challenge, I focus on a collaborative approach that sharpens the scope, clarifies priorities and provides space to critique the relevance and materiality of the model. With a clear understanding of the context, initial prototypes generate feedback loops that improve both development efficiency and utility of the tools that are delivered. Beyond improving the process, by actively test-driving the modeling along the way, investors have better command of the outputs and confidence in their own interpretations.

Areas of Expertise

- Policy/Governance/Risk Tools – Team lead on modeling to frame investment tradeoffs and risk tolerance, including capital market assumptions, tax-efficiency, simulation modeling, multi-asset factor exposures, scenario modeling, private equity pacing/exposure modeling, rebalancing, manager structure, performance risk attribution, currency hedging. Experience characterizing concentrated single stock positions within endowments as well as deep understanding of the math and application of security level equity factor models (e.g. Barra).
- Coaching – Experienced technical coach, with a service mindset (math needs to fit the process, not the other way around). Wide-ranging experience adapting to hundreds of allocators driving a hard-won appreciation of the importance of listening, such that any technical dimensions originate from existing intuition. Appreciation for the utility of well-conceived technical treatments to ground debate and drive collaboration (as tangible view to push against, complementing qualitative dialog).

TAILORED QUANT, LLC | 2023 – Current | Freelance Quant | Investment Risk Advisory

Thought partner (& quant) – Collaborator in framing core questions underlying investment objectives, strategy and process, through an iterative dialog seeking convergence on common language and understanding. Advising, developing, and delivering on relevant risk process design and methods impacting governance and investment management (risk budgeting, efficient risk taking, monitoring).

WELLINGTON MANAGEMENT | 2018 – 2023 | Vice President | Risk Manager | Boston, MA

INVESTMENT PROCESS ENHANCEMENT – develop rapport while learning the objectives, processes, intentions and instincts of 15 lead PMs with range of experience and openness to incorporating a quantitative lens; provided council on notable positioning on an ad hoc basis and designed and implemented custom portfolio construction processes; researched methods, tailored to unique needs of investors and delivered actionable suggestions for ways to mitigate unwanted concentrations (with consideration to capital-, risk- and alpha-efficiency)

INDEPENDENT OVERSIGHT – partner with line managers (ultimate fiduciary) ensuring strategies are managed in line with client expectations, through regular investor-specific discussions and broader platform reviews; provide clients and prospects with understanding of our oversight process and a given team's approach to risk management

CAMBRIDGE ASSOCIATES | 1999 – 2018 | Managing Director 2009 | Boston and London (2008-2010)
Global investment advisory firm of 1000+ employees serving institutional clients, including: non-profit endowed institutions, family offices, pensions, insurance companies and sovereign wealth funds.

SCALABLE RESEARCH/LEADERSHIP – 19 years building and ultimately leading a small team (from 1 to 8) with a broad mandate – research and develop rigorous, scalable modeling foundation to frame critical investment questions across a range of client types. Contributed a rigorous technical perspective to various working groups on tactical asset allocation, pension liability-sensitive risk management, private wealth tax sensitivity, active risk in private equity, including an 18m post in London to review the unique needs of various global clients. Led recruiting (20+ hires), mentoring and primary voice in management/reviews.

CUSTOMIZATION – Deep experience efficiently learning about and ultimately adapting scalable modeling infrastructure to account for critical idiosyncrasies in a client's investment picture, from profiling unique investments (concentrated individual securities, properties or businesses) or incorporating unique liabilities to unique projects like considering a dynamic risk tolerance/asset allocation, concentrating a portfolio (removing line items in a minimally disruptive way) or incorporating tax-efficient considerations. Some of these inquiries required only modest adjustments to standard tooling, others required reasonably light-weight, cost-efficient prototypes that could illustrate the key issues in a cost-effective manner.

EDUCATION | BA, Applied Math, Brown University, Providence, RI (1999)

17 Applied Math, Math and other technical courses. Study abroad UNSW (Sydney, Australia), Intern Los Alamos National Lab (Summer '98). 4 years on alpine race team, without prior race experience, voted most improved 3x, captain, continued for 3 years as assistant coach.

Technical Skills – modeling and coding (python, matlab, vba)